

45b8-80e8-983a48d5e1bd/msicuu2.exe). This is a 350 KB file. Now go to **Start > Programs > Windows Install Clean Up**. Select Microsoft Office 2007 Professional Beta 2 from the list and click the Remove button. Click OK and then Exit. The program deletes only the Office-related Registry entries. The Office 2007 files will remain on the hard disk, so you will have to manually delete them. You will now be able to install any version of Office.

Scan, Select, Save

Q I inadvertently deleted an extended partition on my Seagate 40 GB PATA drive. Can I recover the lost data?

Arvind Kumar Sharma



PC Inspector File Recovery

A As long as your hard drive is recognised by the BIOS, and as long as it has not suffered mechanical damage, you can attempt to recover data from it using software such as the free PC Inspector File Recovery. Download this 6 MB file from www.pcinspector.de/file_recovery/UK/welcome.htm. Install and launch the program. Click on Lost Drive on the left and wait for PC Inspector to scan your hard drives and determine the available partitions. Select your drive in the Logical Drives tab and click on Preview to verify the drive's contents. Click on the tick-mark to start the scan. After the scan is complete, you will be able to view the recoverable contents of the drive. You can select all or any of the files to recover. Right-click on them and select "Save to". Choose a drive or folder to save the recovered files to.

Mode Madness

Q My computer has become very slow, and copying files from one drive to another has become a frustrating affair. I checked the DMA settings in the device manager and found that my hard drive is operating in PIO mode, even though the "DMA if available" option is selected.

Nav S

A Every time Windows boots, it checks each storage device to determine the highest performance that it will offer. If it encounters any problems, such as a faulty cable, it falls back to the next lower speed available, which is from DMA to PIO mode in your case. Replace your hard

drive's data cable. Open the Device Manager and under "IDE ATA/ATAPI Controllers", delete your hard drive controller. Restart Windows; your hard drive should start functioning in DMA mode.

One K = One Thousand?

Q My 80 GB hard disk shows up as 76 GB in Windows Explorer. Where is the remaining 4 GB of space? Have I been cheated? I'd also like to ask you: while capturing from my Sony handycam (mini DV) to the PC using the bundled Picture package software, it captures in parts; these segments are of 10 minutes length. So when I capture a 60-minute video, I get six segments.

Shashishil Kshatriya

A Drive manufacturers specify drive capacities in "Giga Bytes." (A Giga Byte is equal to 1024 "Kilo Bytes" and a Kilo Byte is equal to 1024 Bytes.) But they measure the capacity using 1000 as the multiplier. Specifying the capacity in this way is a marketing gimmick—it shows a larger number. So an "80 GB" hard disk has a capacity of $80 \times 1000 \times 1000 \div 1024 \div 1024$, which is equal to 76.29 GB. This is the capacity you see in Windows Explorer.

Most software capture the digital video content from a DV camera by default in multiple segments. This is known as Scene Detection, where the software tries to recognise major changes in scene. When it encounters such a change, it stops capturing to the current file and continues into the next file. This is to facilitate creating chapters on DVD. It increases file manageability. You will need to explore the options in your capture software to be able to disable this option and capture the video as a single file.

Amnesia

Q Is it possible to recover Excel passwords?

Prabhu Karthikeyan

A There are many tools available to recover passwords for Excel files. Some of these are AOPR 3.11 from www.elcomsoft.com/aopr.html (–49–Rs 3,000—for the Home Edition), Excel Key from www.lostpassword.com/excel.htm (\$45; Rs 2,000), and Excel Password from <http://lastbit.com/excel/> (\$39; Rs 1,750).

Fantelligence!

Q I have an Intel Pentium 4 2.6 GHz on an Intel 915GAV motherboard. Whenever I run two or three applications or when I run a game, the CPU fan runs very fast and makes a lot of noise.

Sagar Ranjankar

A This is normal. Your BIOS supports variable fan-speed control. The fan spins slow when the CPU is idle or under little load. It spins the fastest when the CPU is stressed, such as when running a game, editing video, or anything else that is CPU-intensive. Automatic fan control ensures better balance between cooling and the noise generated by the fan.